

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
TECHNICAL COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR
JUNIOR GRADE OF MIZORAM HEALTH SERVICES (COMBINED) UNDER
HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE DEPARTMENT,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(JULY-2026)

GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

SECTION - A
(60 Marks)

The questions in this Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.

Marks are indicated against each question.

1. Write an essay on any one of the following topics. (20)

- (a) Gender equality and the socio-economic empowerment of women.
- (b) Artificial Intelligence – A friend or a foe?
- (c) The prospect of tourism in Mizoram.

2. Write a precis of the given passage: (20)

Research has shown that the human mind can process words at the rate of about 500 words per minute, whereas a speaker speaks at the rate of about 150 words a minute. The difference between the two at 350 words is quite large.

A speaker must make every effort to retain the attention of the audience. The listener should also be careful not to let his mind wander. Good communication calls for good listening skills. A good speaker must necessarily be a good listener.

Listening starts with hearing but goes beyond. Hearing, in other words, is necessary but is not a sufficient condition for listening. Listening involves hearing with attention. Listening is a process that calls for concentration. While listening, one should also be observant. In other words, listening has to do with the ears, as well as with the eyes and the mind. Listening is to be understood as the total process that involves hearing with attention, being observant and making interpretations. Good communication is essentially an interactive process. It calls for participation and involvement. It is quite often a dialogue rather than a monologue. It is necessary to be interested and also show or make it abundantly clear that one is interested in knowing what the other person has to say.

Good listening is an art that can be cultivated. It relates to skills that can be developed. A good listener knows the art of getting much more than what the speaker is trying to convey. He knows how to prompt, persuade but not to cut off or interrupt what the other person has to say. At times, the speaker may or may not be coherent, articulate and well organised in his thoughts and expressions. He may have it in his mind and yet he may fail to marshal the right words while communicating his thoughts. Nevertheless, a good listener puts him at ease, helps him articulate and facilitates him to get across the message that he wants to convey. For listening to be effective, it is also necessary that barriers to listening are removed. Such barriers can be both physical and psychological. Physical barriers generally relate to hindrance to proper hearing, whereas psychological barriers are more fundamental and relate to the interpretation and evaluation of the speaker and the message.

Direction (Question Nos. 3 – 12): Read the passage, and answer the questions based on the given passage. Marks are indicated against each question:

The happy man is the man who lives objectively, who has free affections and wide interests, who secures his happiness through these interests and affections and through the fact that they in turn make him an object of interest and affection to many others. To be the recipient of affection is a potent cause of happiness, but the man who demands affection is not the man upon whom it is bestowed. The man who receives affection is, speaking broadly, the man who gives it. But it is useless to attempt to give it as a calculation, in the way in which one might lend money at interest, for a calculated affection is not genuine and is not felt to be so by the recipient. What then can a man do who is unhappy because he is encased in self? So long as he continues to think about the causes of his unhappiness, he continues to be self-centered and therefore does not get outside it. It must be by genuine interest, not by simulated interests adopted merely as a medicine. Although this difficulty is real, there is nevertheless much that he can do if he has rightly diagnosed his trouble. If for example, his trouble is due to a sense of sin, conscious or unconscious, he can first persuade his conscious mind that he has no reason to feel sinful, and then proceed, to plant this rational conviction in his unconscious mind, concerning himself meanwhile with some more or less neutral activity. If he succeeds in dispelling the sense of sin, it is possible that genuine objective interests will arise spontaneously. If his trouble is self-pity, he can deal with it in the same manner after first persuading himself that there is nothing extraordinarily unfortunate in his circumstances. If fear is his trouble, let him practise exercises designed to give courage. Courage has been recognized from time immemorial as an important virtue, and a great part of the training of boys and young men has been devoted to producing a type of character capable of fearlessness in battle. But moral courage and intellectual courage have been much less studied. They also, however, have their technique. Admit to yourself every day at least one painful truth, you will find it quite useful. Teach yourself to feel that life would still be worth living even if you were not, as of course you are, immeasurably superior to all your friends in virtue and in intelligence. Exercises of this sort prolonged through several years will at last enable you to admit facts without flinching and will, in so doing, free you from the empire of fear over a very large field.

3. According to the passage, the happy man is the one _____. (1)
 - (a) who is free from worldly passions
 - (b) who has externally centred passions
 - (c) who has free affection and wide interests
 - (d) who is encased in self
4. Which of the following virtues, according to the passage, has been recognised for long as an important virtue? (1)
 - (a) Courage
 - (b) Self-consciousness
 - (c) Sacrifice
 - (d) Patriotism
5. According to the passage, calculated affection: (1)
 - (a) turns into permanent affection over a period of time
 - (b) leads to self-pity
 - (c) makes other person to love you
 - (d) appears to be false and fabricated
6. What happens when you think about the cause of your unhappiness? (1)
 - (a) You try to practice exercise designed to give coverage.
 - (b) You remain a self-centered person.
 - (c) You realize that life can be lived in different ways.
 - (d) You try to introspect and look critically at yourself.
7. What according to the passage is the real cause of happiness? (1)
 - (a) Affection received from others
 - (b) Calculated risk taken
 - (c) Critical analysis of the happy state of mind
 - (d) Material rewards and incentives received

8. How can one get out of the vicious circle mentioned in the passage? (1)
- (a) Being true to others and one's internal circumstances
 - (b) Admitting to oneself that others could be right
 - (c) By inculcating the habit of self-absorption
 - (d) By practicing skills of concentration
9. Which of the following statements is **TRUE** in the context of the passage? (1)
- (a) Any virtue has a dark side also.
 - (b) One feels happy if one receives affection.
 - (c) The happy man lives subjectively.
 - (d) Any affection is always genuine.
10. Find a word in the passage which is a synonym of '*conferred*'. (1)
11. Find a word in the passage which is a synonym of '*wincing*'. (1)
12. Find a word in the passage which is the antonym of '*accumulating*'. (1)
13. Make sentences with each word in the pair to bring out their difference: (5×2=10)
- | | |
|-----------------------------|------------------|
| (a) Live / life | (b) Wide / width |
| (c) Affection / affectation | (d) Mind / mine |
| (e) Exercise / exorcise | |

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice Questions) (40 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1. Attempt all questions.

*The questions in this Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1 – 5): Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the verb given in brackets:

1. Many foreign birds _____ to India these days.
(a) come (b) came
(c) were coming (d) coming
2. Most major cities _____ significantly over the last 30 years.
(a) grew (b) have grown
(c) will grow (d) had grown
3. I _____ her for a long time.
(a) know (b) knew
(c) will know (d) have known
4. After hiking for an hour, we _____ to gather our strength.
(a) stop (b) stops
(c) stopped (d) stopping
5. I will call you when the guests _____.
(a) will arrive (b) would arrive
(c) arrive (d) had arrive

Direction (Question Nos. 6 – 10): Choose the correct meaning of the following idioms and phrases:

6. To toe the line:
(a) Mark a line (b) To be different
(c) Hurt one's foot (d) Follow others
7. To go scot-free:
(a) To walk like a native in Scotland (b) To get something free of charge
(c) To escape without punishment (d) To walk naked
8. Shedding crocodile tears:
(a) To weep profusely. (b) To pretend to grieve
(c) To grieve seriously (d) To mock something
9. Face the music:
(a) Enjoying a musical recital (b) To bear the consequences
(c) To enjoy a romantic atmosphere (d) To have a difficult time
10. Smell a rat:
(a) Emitting a foul odour (b) See a rat
(c) To get rid of a pest (d) Be suspicious

Direction (Question Nos. 11 – 15): Fill in the blanks using the correct preposition:

11. On the advice of her doctor, she is _____ a diet.
(a) at (b) in
(c) on (d) off
12. The rich are not inured _____ manual labour.
(a) by (b) of
(c) on (d) to
13. There is a small wooden bridge _____ the stream.
(a) over (b) on
(c) upon (d) under
14. The fans shouted _____ joy after their team won the match
(a) in (b) for
(c) from (d) with
15. There is no limit _____ the wants of man.
(a) for (b) to
(c) on (d) of

Direction (Question Nos. 16 – 20): Out of the four alternatives, choose the one which can be substituted for the given words/sentences:

16. One who is always doubting:
(a) sceptic (b) deist
(c) rationalist (d) positivist
17. Unfair advantages to member of one's own family:
(a) optimism (b) plagiarism
(c) nepotism (d) regionalism
18. An inscription on a tomb:
(a) epitaph (b) epilogue
(c) eulogy (d) elegy
19. A recurrent compulsive urge to steal:
(a) kleptomania (b) insomnia
(c) narcissism (d) nymphomania
20. Of one mind or opinion:
(a) resolution (b) referendum
(c) homogenous (d) unanimous

Direction (Question Nos. 21 – 25): Fill in the blanks using the correct pronouns from the given options:

21. The Cabinet gave _____ vote today.
(a) its (b) their
(c) theirs (d) it's
22. I really like watching old movies. _____ are some of the best things on TV.
(a) Those (b) That
(c) This (d) These

23. Mawii is the receptionist _____ I have employed in my new office.
(a) who (b) which
(c) whose (d) whom
24. Let _____ who can, save her from drowning.
(a) he (b) him
(c) it (d) their
25. _____ flavour do you prefer to have?
(a) What (b) Which
(c) Who (d) Whom

Direction (Question Nos. 26 – 30): Given below are sentences in active/passive voice. Out of the four alternatives suggested, select one which best expresses the same sentence in passive/active voice:

26. We must endure what we cannot cure.
(a) What we cure must be endured. (b) What cannot be cured must be endured.
(c) What cannot cure must endured. (d) What could be cure must be endured.
27. Who asked you to draft this letter?
(a) By who you are asked to draft this letter?
(b) By who have you been asked to draft this letter?
(c) By whom were you asked to draft this letter?
(d) By whom you were asked to draft this letter?
28. One must keep one's promises.
(a) One's promises are kept. (b) One's promises must keep.
(c) One's promises were kept. (d) One's promises must be kept.
29. He had committed a mistake.
(a) A mistake had committed by him. (b) A mistake was committed by him.
(c) A mistake had been committed by him. (d) A mistake has been committed by him.
30. It is being read by us.
(a) We are reading it. (b) It will be read by us.
(c) We can read it. (d) We have to read it.

Direction (Question Nos: 31 – 35): Change the sentences from the given options as directed against each question:

31. The fans shouted "Hurrah, we are the Champions!" (Change to indirect speech)
(a) The fans said that they are the Champions.
(b) The fans chanted that they are Champions.
(c) The fans exclaimed with joy that they are the Champions.
(d) The fans shouted with joy that they are Arsenal.
32. It was a perfect idea (Change into interrogative sentence)
(a) Wasn't it a perfect idea? (b) What an idea!
(c) Alas! It was not a good idea. (d) Whose idea was it?
33. India grows very fast. (Change into exclamatory sentence)
(a) Hello India! (b) My India is great!
(c) Is India growing? (d) How fast India grows!

34. Aizawl is much _____ than Delhi. (*Choose the most appropriate*)
(a) cool (b) cooler
(c) coolest (d) cold
35. Superman cannot be destroyed. (*Change into an affirmative sentence*)
(a) Superman is indestructable. (b) Superman is invisible.
(c) Superman is inaudible. (d) Superman is not a human.

Direction (Question Nos. 36 – 40): Choose the correct part of speech as directed of the underlined words given based on how they are used in the given sentence:

36. The youth ran across the street. (Type of noun)
(a) Collective (b) Common
(c) Abstract (d) Material
37. It was a lovely evening walk. (Type of adjective)
(a) Quality (b) Quantity
(c) Demonstrative (d) Exclamatory
38. Wasted time never returns. (Type of adverb)
(a) Frequency (b) Place
(c) Time (d) Manner
39. The stranger is welcomed as such. (Type of pronoun)
(a) Indefinite (b) Relative
(c) Reflexive (d) Demonstrative
40. Place these boxes on the shelf. (Type of adjective)
(a) Demonstrative (b) Quantity
(c) Distributive (d) Possessive

* * * * *